AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

## Faculty of Business Studies

# B328
## Marketing in Action

## Final Examination / Version: B
## 2025-2026 / SPRING

## 2 – June - 2026

AOU EGYPT

| Number of Exam Pages: | Time Allowed: |
|---|---|
| 3 pages | 3 hours |

## Instructions:

1- Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF"** mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- You **MUST** answer the questions using only the answer booklets provided
5- You **MUST** return the examination paper together with your answer booklets.
6- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
7- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examination
8- Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
9- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

**QUESTION 1 (15 marks)**

**Case Study: TrendLoop – The Fast Fashion Machine**
TrendLoop is a global fast fashion brand that releases **hundreds of new clothing items each season**, often inspired by viral social media trends and celebrity outfits. Its marketing emphasizes immediacy: limited-time collections, flash sales, and "must-have" items that are only available for a few days.

A recent campaign encouraged users to post outfits online, tag friends, and use the hashtag #TrendLoopStyle to show they were "in the know." TrendLoop collaborated with micro-influencers, who frequently showcased entire wardrobe hauls, comparing pieces and creating lookbooks to guide followers.

Shoppers often purchased multiple variations of the same item, different colors or sizes so they could replicate influencer looks, post frequent outfit updates, or trade with friends. Some collections sold out in hours, while online forums buzzed with tips on how to buy quickly and resell items for a small profit.

Despite highlighting style, affordability, and accessibility, TrendLoop's campaigns implicitly encouraged **rapid, repeated purchasing**, blending social recognition with instant gratification. Consumers were not only responding to trends they were actively participating in amplifying them, creating a cycle of demand, visibility, and excess consumption.

**Q1a.** Discuss how the fast fashion industry illustrates the link between consumerism and over-consumption**. (7.5 marks)**

**Q1b.** Evaluate the role of consumers in driving or reducing over-consumption in the fast fashion industry. **(7.5 marks)**

**QUESTION 2 (15 marks)**

Describe the TEARS model of credibility by explaining its five sub-criteria and support your answer with relevant brand examples. (**10 + 5 marks**)

**QUESTION 3 (15 marks)**

**Q3a**. Define the concept of value co-creation and explain **three** ways in which individuals can participate in value co-creation within the context of social marketing. (**11 marks**)

**Q3b.** Discuss two challenges faced when applying value co-creation in social marketing. (**4 marks**)

AOU EGYPT

**QUESTION 4 (5 marks)**

**Reflection on Your TMA:** This question will ask you to *reflect* on the TMA you submitted earlier in the semester.

- You will need to discuss what you learned from completing the TMA, how the assignment helped deepen your understanding of the course concepts, and how you can apply these insights in real-world scenarios.
- Reflect on your strengths and areas for improvement, providing thoughtful and honest insights.

**END OF QUESTION PAPER**

AOU EGYPT